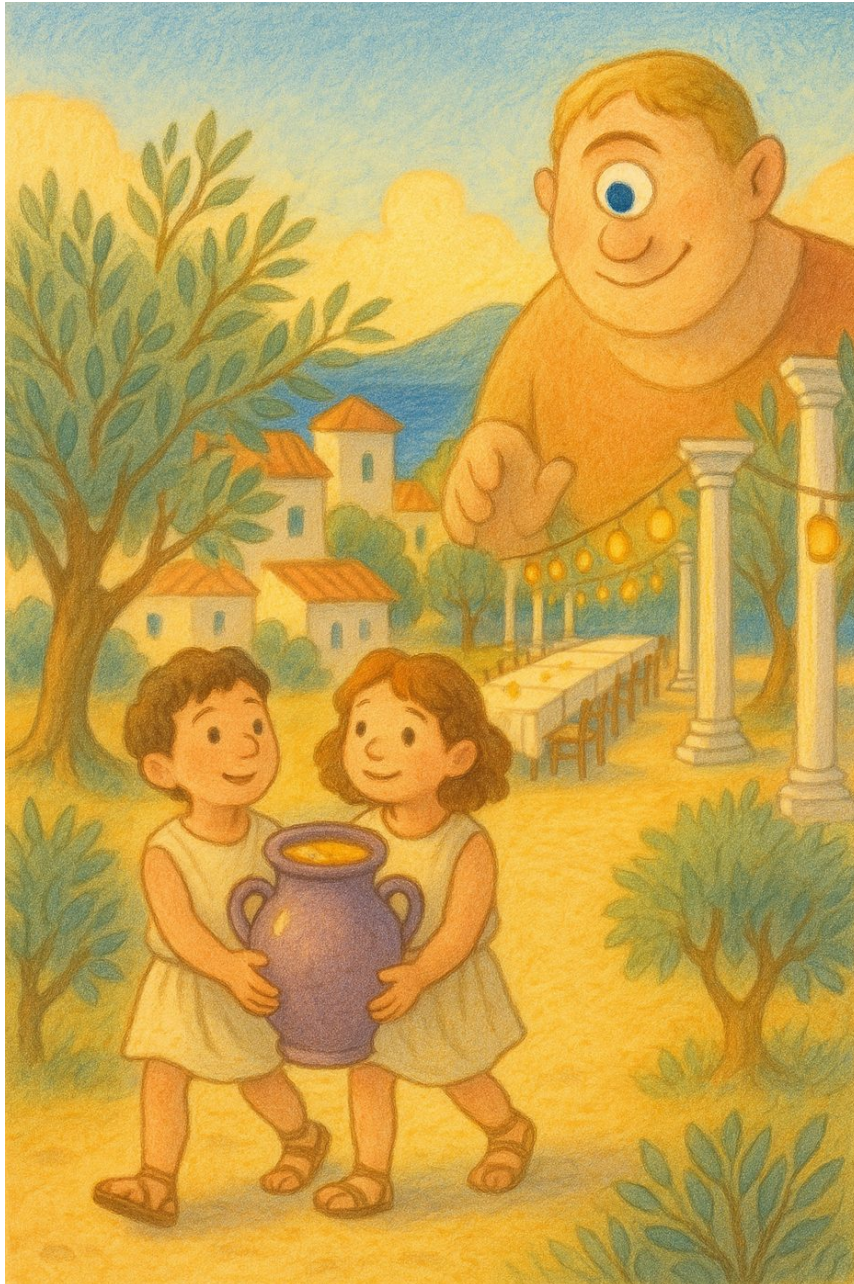


The Honey-Cake Feast

The sunlit hills of Greece roll down to a bright blue sea, dotted with olive groves, white marble columns, and little towns where everyone knows your name. High above, hidden in the clouds of Mount Olympus, the gods watch over the world, and the hills are full of wonders: riddling sphinxes, kindly centaurs, shy satyrs, and nymphs who sing by the springs. Here a hero is not the strongest or the loudest, but the one who keeps a cool head, asks good questions, and stands by a friend. The grandest deeds are done by being clever and brave and kind. Even a fearsome guardian, met with courage and a fair word, often turns out to be lonelier than it is wicked.



The Honey-Cake Feast

Read aloud, or let an older child read it themselves. Pause at each question so the heroes can decide together. There are no wrong answers here, only kinder ideas to try.

Before you begin

There was a feast in the making in the Olive Town, and the whole valley could feel it. Long tables were being carried out beneath the olive trees, lanterns were being strung between the branches, and from every doorway drifted the warm smell of baking. The reason was the happiest one of all: for the first time ever, the great gentle Cyclops was coming down from the hills to join the town, for he was their friend now and lonely no longer. And to welcome him, the bakers were making the largest honey cake the hills had ever seen.

There was only one trouble. The honey jar stood empty. Old Daphne, keeper of the olive grove, called the two of you to her side. "You have busy hands and kind hearts," she said, "and a feast is built on both. Will you gather what we still need, and bring our big friend safely down to the table?"

She pressed an empty jar into your hands and smiled. "Remember," she said, "in this town we do not feast by leaving anyone out. We share what we have, and we always make room for one more."

What is your hero name? Which quality will you carry: Wits, Courage, or Heart?

Stop 1: The Hill of Bees



The path led up to a sunny meadow humming with life, where the Hill Bees kept the sweetest honey in all the Sunlit Hills. They wheeled in busy golden circles about their hive, and it was plain at once that anyone who rushed in or snatched would be met with nothing but an empty jar and a cloud of buzzing.

How might you ask the bees to share their honey? Could you move slowly and keep yourselves calm? Could you offer them a gift of meadow flowers first, and ask politely? What do you try?

When you came gently and asked with kindness, the Hill Bees hummed their approval and swarmed about your jar in a friendly golden whirl, filling it to the very brim. "For a friend, and for a feast," they buzzed, "gladly."

Stop 2: Milo's Kitchen



Back in the warm bustle of the town, Milo the baker had pulled from his oven a honey cake so vast it took up his whole table. But a cake is only as good as the sharing of it, and here was the puzzle: how to cut it so that every single guest had a piece, the smallest child and the enormous Cyclops alike, and nobody went without.

Let us work it out together. How many friends are coming to the feast? How could you cut the cake so that everyone has enough, with a slice grand enough for a giant? A fair share, remember, is not always a share of the same size.

When you counted the guests and shared the cake with care, every plate in the town was filled, and the grandest slice of all stood waiting for your giant friend.

Stop 3: Fetching the Friend



Up you climbed to the mouth of the Cyclops's cave. He was overjoyed to see you, but when he understood that a whole townful of people was waiting below, he looked down at his enormous feet and his smile faltered. "A whole town?" he said. "But I am so very big. What if there is no room for me? What if they take one look and are afraid?"

He had found his kindness long ago, but just now he needed a little courage. What gentle thing could you say to him? Could you tell him plainly that he is wanted? Could you show him the great slice you had saved, and offer to walk down at his side? What do you do?

When you reassured him with warm and honest words, the giant's worry melted, and a smile spread slowly across his whole broad face. He folded one huge hand carefully around yours, and together, step by gentle step, you came down the hill to the feast.

Everyone at the Table



As the sun slipped low and gold over the bay, the whole Olive Town gathered at one long table beneath the olive trees, and there in the very middle, with the largest slice of honey cake balanced happily on one knee, sat the Cyclops, roaring with laughter among his new friends.

No one had been left out. Every plate was full, every lantern was lit, and every face around the table was glad. High on cloud-wrapped Olympus, wise Athena looked down on the feast and smiled.

You had done it, and you had done it together: with your wits, with your courage, and above all with your kindness. Well done, heroes of the Sunlit Hills.



My Adventure Sheet

Draw your hero

MY NAME

I AM A HERO OF

My energy



Colour one in when you spend it

My magics

draw it

My magic is _____

It can _____

draw it

My magic is _____

It can _____

draw it

My magic is _____

It can _____

What I carry

☐ _____

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Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.



Wits and Wonder

Story Pack

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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Version 3.6, updated 2026-06-04, en-GB



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